

027. Chapter 3 Verses 1-3

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.1

अर्जुन उवाच ।
ज्यायसी चेत्कर्मणस्ते मता बुद्धिर्जनार्दन ।
तत्किं कर्मणि घोरे मां नियोजयसि केशव ॥ १ ॥

arjuna uvāca |
jyāyasī cetkarmaṇaste
matā buddhirjanārdana |
tatkiṃ karmaṇi ghore mām
niyojayasi keśava ||

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ jyāyasī – superior; cet – if; karmaṇaḥ – than action; te – by You; ◆ matā – thought; buddhiḥ – intellect/wisdom; janārdana – O Janardana; ◆ tat – then; kim – why; karmaṇi – in action; ghore – ghastly/terrible; mām – me; ◆ niyojayasi – You engage; keśava – O Kesava.

Arjuna said: O Krishna! If your belief is that knowledge is superior to action, then why do you engage me in this dreadful act of battle?

VERSE 3.2

व्यामिश्रेणेव वाक्येन बुद्धिं मोहयसीव मे ।
तदेकं वद निश्चित्य येन श्रेयोऽहमाप्नुयाम् ॥ २ ॥

vyāmiśreṇeva vākyena
buddhiṃ mohayasīva me |
tadekaṃ vada niścitya
yena śreya'hamāpnuyām ||

◆ vyāmiśreṇa – equivocal/confusing; iva – as if; vākyena – by words; ◆ buddhiṃ – intellect; mohayasi – You confuse; iva – as it were; me – my; ◆ tat – that; ekam – one; vada – tell; niścitya – decisively; ◆ yena – by which; śreyaḥ – the highest good; aham – I; āpnuyām – may attain.

With these apparently contradictory words, You seem to confuse my understanding. Therefore tell me definitely that one thing by which I shall reach the Highest Goal.

VERSE 3.3

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
लोकेऽस्मिन्द्विविधा निष्ठा पुरा प्रोक्ता मया नघ ।
ज्ञानयोगेन साङ्ख्यानां कर्मयोगेन योगिनाम् ॥ ३ ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
loke'smindvividhā niṣṭhā
purā proktā mayānagha |
jñānayogena sāṅkhyānām
karmayogena yoginām ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ loke – in the world; asmin – in this; dvividhā – two-fold; niṣṭhā – path/discipline; ◆ purā – formerly; proktā – was declared; mayā – by Me; anagha – O sinless one; ◆ jñāna-yogena – by the path of Knowledge; sāṅkhyānām – for the Sankhyas; karma-yogena – by the path of Action; yoginām – for the Yogis.

The Blessed Lord said: O sinless Arjuna! In ancient times two paths of spiritual description were spoken by me – the Jnana yoga for the followers of the path of knowledge, and Karma yoga for the followers of the path of action.